

Old Testament





About the Course

Students in Grades 3-6 read Old Testament narratives chronologically. For 2026-2027, students read selections from Joshua, Judges, Ruth, and 1-2 Samuel. Lesson plans also include selections from maps and books such as The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times, which teachers can read or share with their students to help them understand the biblical context and gain insight into the culture and geography of Israel.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grade 3, Bible: Grades 4-6



Placement & Combining Tips

Suitable for older students if combining lessons, and ideal for older students just getting familiar with the Bible.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
3-6	Old Testament: Grades 3-6 2 times/week 20 min	ESV Large Print Bible The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grade 3				
Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Church History: Grades 1-3
Bible: Grades 4-6				
Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Church History: Grades 4-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Old Testament: Grades 3-6



ESV Large Print Bible



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 6: Bible\)](#)
- ∞ [How can we find the original meaning of the text?](#)
- ∞ [How do we help students learn to interpret the Bible?](#)
- ∞ [How does learning about the Ancient Near East world help us understand the Bible?](#)
- ∞ [What is the role of the Holy Spirit when reading the Bible?](#)

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Old Testament: Grades 3-6

How To Teach



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Read

- Read the chapter or selection aloud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the students' pace during the lesson, rather than feeling that a particular number of pages must be completed. It is vitally important that teachers not overload students with more material than they can absorb in one sitting.
- Students who have difficulty sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Students with regular difficulty engaging often benefit from having a picture to associate with the story WHILE listening. Feel free to view the artwork during the reading rather than after the narration.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



View

- Optional: Share a piece of fine art that illustrates the story.



Discuss

- Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
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Old Testament: Grades 3-6

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Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 1

Introduction to Joshua

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

PREP: The teacher may wish to read the article linked here that explains the genre of Historical or Historical Narrative books of the Bible. The focus is always on who God is (known as the theology of God) while the history of his people is told.

∞ Article Link: [Introduction to the Old Testament Historical Books](#)

→ INTRO

This year in the Old Testament, we will read five books: Joshua, Judges, Ruth, 1 and 2 Samuel. These books continue the story of Israel so that when we open our Bible to the book of Joshua, it is as though we are starting to read in the middle of a story where important events and people have already been introduced and discussed.

In order to understand what is going to happen next, let's do a short review of what has happened so far. The first five books of the Bible are a group of books called the Pentateuch. The Pentateuch is the books of Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, and Deuteronomy. The next set, or category, has twelve books in it and is called Historical or Historical Narrative. We will read the first five of these books this year. Historical narrative books show us who God is while the story of his people, the Israelites, is told. When you read a historical narrative book, you will see that it answers the question, "And then what happened?"

What do you recall about what has happened so far in the life of Israel? (Students may mention Abraham, Moses, being in Egypt, plagues in Egypt, crossing the Red Sea, etc.)

Leaders of Israel have included Abraham, who received a promise from God that He would bless him with land, people, and many blessings. Next, the nation of Israel was led by Moses. Moses led the people as they escaped from Egypt, crossed the Red Sea, and wandered in the wilderness.

God made a covenant (promise) with Moses that if the people followed God, they would be blessed. But if they disobeyed, they would be cursed (things would not go well for them). For today's reading, we are going to read a passage from the book of Deuteronomy where the covenant God made with Moses is written about. As we read Joshua, Judges, Ruth, and First and Second Samuel, these promises will be underlying the decisions the people and leaders of Israel make, so it is an important chapter to keep in our minds as we read. Will they continue to follow God, or will they forget about him and turn to their own selfish ways? We will find out as we read the Historical Narrative books and find out the answer to "And then what happened?"

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Deuteronomy 28:1-10, 15-19, 25

- What did God promise (or covenant) with the people of Israel?

→ NOTEBOOK

This year, you will keep a notebook. Suggestions will be given in lessons for drawing or writing what you have read about, but you can always add drawings or writings of your own choosing as well.

Today, open up your notebook and create a title page with the heading: Old Testament.

As time and ability allow, write the names of the books we will be covering this year: Joshua, Judges, Ruth, 1 Samuel, and 2 Samuel. You can also write the genre of these books: Historical Narrative.

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 2

Joshua Commissioned

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook, Student Bible Atlas

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the intro to Joshua from last time?

→ INTRO

Before he died, Moses passed on the leadership of the people of Israel to Joshua (Deut. 31:7-8). In today's reading, Joshua will speak to the people about entering the Promised Land—the nation of Canaan. As Joshua speaks, he reminds the people of what they should do to have success and blessings. He also says, "Be strong and courageous." The reason the people could be strong and courageous is because the Lord was going with them and preparing their way. As we read, count how many times you hear this phrase or words similar to this.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Joshua 1:1-18

- How many times did he say "Be strong and courageous"? Why do you think he repeated that command?
- How would you feel if you were an Israelite about to enter the Promised Land?

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas p.8-9 Maps 4 and 5

1. At the end of Deuteronomy, we are told that before he died, Moses "went up from the plains of Moab to Mount Nebo" (Deut. 34:1) and was shown the Promised Land. On Map 4 (the larger map), locate Moab, the Jordan River (labeled as "R. Jordan"), and Canaan.
2. Look at the image in the bottom right-hand corner to see the view from Mount Nebo.
3. Looking at Map 5, locate Mt Nebo and the Jordan River. Follow the arrows to see the direction the Israelites will move forward in the book of Joshua. The Jordan River moves north to south, and to the east is a plateau (mostly flat, level ground) and mountains to the left. The people are approaching Canaan from the south. The first move they will have to make is to cross the Jordan River.

→ NOTEBOOK

In your notebook, create a title page for the book of Joshua. Draw a picture of Joshua speaking to the Israelites as their new leader. As time and ability allow, write the phrase "Be strong and courageous." Older students might write a short summary of the passage or a key verse from the passage.

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 3

Rahab Hides the Spies

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs of Bible Times

NOTE: Two different options are given for the reading from Manners & Customs. Choose which one best fits the age or the interests of your student(s). This book will be used throughout the year to give background explanation of the customs of the people at the time. Because the book covers the entire Bible, at times other verses will be referenced, but selections have been chosen to give background to the Old Testament books we are reading.



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→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Joshua is going to send two spies into the land to check it out. Maybe he thought back to how he had once been a spy for Moses!

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Joshua 2:1-24

- Deuteronomy 28:10 says, "And all the peoples of the earth shall see that you are called by the name of the Lord, and they shall be afraid of you." How does what Rahab says and does agree with (or prove) this verse from Deuteronomy? (If needed, see Josh. 2:9-11, 24)

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Rahab's family lived in a house that was part of the walls of Jericho. Read the following passage for an idea of what this may have looked like.

Manners & Customs "Brick Houses"

Younger students: View the illustrations and read p.28 "When the semi-nomadic" - "stone was white."; p.30-31 "The flat roof" - "in Matthew 24:17."

Older students, or as time and interest allow: View the illustrations and read p.28-31 "When the semi-nomadic" - "in Matthew 24:17."

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 4

Crossing the Jordan

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read in Joshua last time?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Joshua 3:7-17; 4:15-24

- How would the stones help the children (or future generations) remember what happened at the Jordan River? If you were there and someone asked you what the stones were for, what would you answer?
- What do God's miracles tell us about God?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's passage. Older students may pick a key verse or phrase from today's reading to write as well.

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 5

The Walls Fall

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

1. Israel celebrates Passover and remembers how God has delivered them from Egypt.

Read Joshua 5:10-15.

- In verse 12, it says the manna stopped. How do you think the Israelites felt about that?

2. Read Joshua 6:1-19.

Jericho is the first city the Israelites need to conquer, as Jericho protects



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the entry into the land from the east, where they crossed the Jordan. Scholars say Jericho "was about a twelve-acre site...[and] Based on the size of the site today, it seems that it might have taken Joshua's army less than half an hour to march around the city walls...In the ancient world every war was holy war because people believed that their gods called them to war, led them in battle, and fought on their behalf...For this assault it was the ark and the priests that gave indication of God's presence with the Israelites and made it plain that the battle belonged to the Lord." (Bible Story Handbook, Walton) Usually, when an army defeated a city or people, they would take the plunder or goods (such as jewelry and anything that was worth a lot). In this case, the people did not take anything, because it wasn't they that claimed the victory—it was God who won this battle.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Sound of the Shofar

View the video showing various Jewish people blowing the shofar, the ram's horn trumpet that was used in Israel's history—and is still used today—to call people to worship. What would it have been like to hear this sound if you were part of the army marching around Jericho?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of what you read today. Older students might write out a key verse from this passage or write a longer summary.

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 6

Achan's Sin

📖 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Last time, we saw that the people did not take any of the plunder from Jericho as they were directed by God: "But all silver and gold, and every vessel of bronze and iron, are holy to the Lord; they shall go into the treasury of the Lord." (6:19) The word "plunder" means the valuables or possessions that would be taken from the people defeated in war. Armies that won battles would take the plunder not only to celebrate the victory, but to add the loot to their money pile so they could afford to keep battling! After the battle at Jericho, everyone followed this rule and listened...except Achan.

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 7:1-25

"When Achan took goods as plunder, it was like making a claim that the Israelites had won the battle rather than the Lord."

→ READ & DISCUSS

Manners & Customs of the Bible "War and religion" (See note above.) p.268-269 "It was not" - "his own people."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview verses 24 and 25 where Achan and his family are killed because of his disobedience.

Preview Manners & Customs reading regarding warfare. Either summarize or skip the couple of sentences that may not be appropriate for younger students.

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 7

Tricked

📖 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO



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Two events happen in today's passage. Do you recall what genre the book of Joshua is? (Historical Narrative) In a narrative (story), events are told as though someone is asking, "And then what happened?"

First, Joshua renews the covenant that God had given to Moses. Do you remember what God promised Moses? (Deut. 28 - If you follow and obey God, then you will be blessed. If you do not follow or obey God, then you will be cursed, and things will not go well.)

As we read the story, we might ask, "And then what happened?"

Next, some kings in the land of Canaan come up with a sneaky plan to trick the Israelites. In this context, a "king is the ruler of a single city," and these cities were starting to worry about the Israelites. Why do you think they were worried?

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 8:30-9:15

- Why do you think it is good for Joshua to renew the covenant God had made with Moses and remind the people what God had said?
- The Gibeonites dressed in old clothes and brought stale food to try to give the impression that they had traveled from a faraway land. Unfortunately, Joshua and the Israelites "did not ask counsel from the Lord" (9:14). Now they are in a treaty with people from the land of Canaan. What do you think will happen?

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 8

The Sun Stands Still

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The Gibeonites have tricked Joshua, but he will remain faithful to the treaty he made with them. Five kings in the land of Canaan decide to come fight against the Gibeonites because now they are all getting worried about the strength of Gibeon and of the Israelites. Next, the Historical Narrative book of Joshua will answer the question, "And then what happened?"

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 9:16-21; 10:1-14

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: Joshua Commanding the Sun to Stand Still Upon Gibeon

- What do you notice about this painting? Do you see the people, and do you see Joshua? What do you notice in the sky?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw or write a short summary in your notebook about today's reading. Older students may choose a key verse or write a longer summary.

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 9

Conquering the Land

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, Student Bible Atlas

NOTE: Today's reading will cover three chapters, but it will skip verses for time's sake.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?



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→ INTRO

Today's reading covers three chapters of information about Joshua and the Israelites defeating various kings in Canaan. These stories of Israel conquering the Promised Land point to God's might and power in fighting for his people, Israel. They are in covenant with him. Do you remember what the word "covenant" means? (a promise) Because God *is* faithful, he will *be* faithful.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Today's reading is in two parts:

1. Joshua 10:42-43

- Who did the fighting for Israel, and what is happening as a result? (All the kings are being captured.)

2. Eventually, Israel captures all the kings, and they will have some rest from fighting. While there were many kings who were defeated, we will read just one of the lists of their names.

Joshua 11:23; 12:7-24

→ MAP

📍 Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas p.10 Map 6

Look at the map and note the red dashed line. What does the map key state this red line shows? (Area permanently controlled by Israel.) Do you recognize any of the names of cities on the map that you have heard or read about?

WEEK 5 📅 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 10

Dividing the Land

📖 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, Student Bible Atlas, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Joshua chapter 13 all the way through chapter 21 lists how Joshua divided up the land between the tribes of Israel. After all, the book of Joshua "shows how God kept his covenant promise to give the land to Israel. He prepared them to enter Canaan, sent his commander to lead them, provided aid in battles, distributed the land, and renewed the covenant. The division of land, though not much of a story, is an incredible climax of the process that had brought the Israelites from their slavery in Egypt to the land that God had promised to Abraham through the covenant made over four centuries earlier. This is fulfillment of covenant promise on a grand scale." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

Our reading will be in three parts:

1. Read Joshua 14:1-5.

2. Read Joshua 16:1-10. Chapter 16 is an example of what these chapters list as far as boundaries of the inherited land that each tribe received. Other chapters define the boundary of the other tribes' lands.

3. Read Joshua 21:43-45. These verses give a summary of the purpose of the entire book of Joshua. They could be called the Key Verses or Main Verses of the book.

- How would you summarize the purpose of the book of Joshua according to these verses?

→ READ

📍 Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas, p.11 Map 7 "Dividing the Land"



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On the map, find the area that was given to the tribe of Ephraim that you read about in chapter 16. Locate the Jordan River. Why would it be good to have your land inheritance touch water?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students may consider copying down the key verses of Joshua (21:43-45) or writing a summary of today's reading.

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 11

Joshua Gets Ready for Goodbye

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook; Manners & Customs of Bible Times

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

In the first verse of today's reading, Joshua states that he is now old. He gives the first of two speeches to the people of Israel. Imagine you are Joshua. What would you think would be important to tell the people in one of your last speeches you will ever be able to give them?

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 23:1-15

→ READ & NARRATE

Although the people were moving into a land where some cities had walls and homes built (as we read about Jericho), tents were also still used at this time. Read the passages on tents and dwellings, and view the images on p.25 about how a tent was erected.

Manners & Customs "Dwellings" p.20-21 "There are two" - "Ahab for this reason.";

"The Tent" p.24-26 "The tent of" - "door of the leader."

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a sentence about today's reading. Older students may draw, write a summary, or copy down a key verse (or more!) from Joshua's speech.

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 12

Meeting at Shechem

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The first part of today's reading might make you think, "Hm, I feel like I've heard this before." God is speaking through Joshua to remind the people of Israel about their history. The story is given using the personal pronoun "I," which is used 18 times in these verses. "I took...I gave...I sent...I plagued...I brought...I delivered, etc." Speaking in the first person (by repeatedly using the word "I") in the telling of the history, God reminds the people who won the battles thus far and who brought them to where they are today as a people. "God reviewed the marvelous deeds he had performed for Israel's benefit...From first to last Israel's conquests, deliverances, and prosperity were because of God's good mercies and were not of their own making." (The Bible Knowledge Commentary)

"Now therefore" begins verse 14. The word "therefore" is an adverb that



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means "as a result" or "for that reason." In other words, the people had been reminded of God's leading, and now, as a result of that, they had a decision to make. Read the passage and see what it is they have to choose.

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 24:1-15

- Because God had brought them that far in their story (or history), what choice did they now need to make?
- What do you think their response will be? (We will find out what their actual response was in our next reading.)

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw or write a summary of today's reading. Older students may write a longer summary or write down a key verse from the passage.

Alternative Option: As time allows, a short summary of the entire book of Joshua can be written or discussed out loud. Questions could include: What happened in Joshua? Were the people following God? What was Joshua like as a leader?

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 13

The Choice

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

We are coming to the end of the book of Joshua. Overall, the people have obeyed and followed after God in the book of Joshua. And, according to Deuteronomy 28, what will be the result of following after God? (The people will receive blessings in the form of having land, fruitful crops, lots of kids or growth of their nation, and things will go well for them.) Did they receive blessings as Joshua led them into Canaan? In what way(s)? (conquered enemies, inherited actual land for their tribes, food to eat, no more manna, etc.)

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 24:16-33

- When the people say that they will serve the Lord, Joshua doesn't seem to believe that they are sincere or genuine. He says, "You are not able to serve the Lord, for he is a holy God. He is a jealous God." What was Joshua emphasizing by saying God was a holy and jealous God? (God is the only God, and their loyalty cannot be divided between other gods and idols. It is not God plus something else.)
- Eventually, he tells them exactly what they need to do. "He had heard the pledge on their lips; now he challenged them to prove their sincerity by their works...There could be no mixing of allegiance to God with idol-worship. A firm choice had to be made then, as in every generation." (Bible Knowledge Commentary) At the end of the passage, Joshua—as the final act of his leadership of Israel—renews the covenant between God and the people. God would bless them if they followed him, and they would be cursed if they did not follow him.

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs p.82 and p.86 (Skip the pages of maps) "When the Jewish" - "began to advance."

→ NOTEBOOK

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Draw a picture or write a short summary of Joshua renewing the covenant at Shechem. Older students may write down a key verse or write a longer summary of the back-and-forth of Joshua and the people.

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 14

Judges Begins

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

While the Israelites followed God as they entered Canaan, there were little seeds of disobedience showing up throughout the book of Joshua. Now, in the book of Judges, unfortunately, those seeds grow into full disobedience. The book tells the history of Israel over centuries, but the book also encourages the Israelites to obey and be faithful to God.

The word "judges" might remind us of a courtroom; however, at this time in history, the judges were "tribal or national leaders. Often they were military commanders." They would settle arguments and give advice to the people of their territory. "Since Israel had no king or other central political figure, the judges played an important role in Israel's survival." (Basic Bible Commentary)

Sadly, as the book continues, the Israelite's turn further and further away from God, and things are very dark and rather disturbing. Throughout the book, certain judges will be introduced, and we will focus on their stories.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 1:27-36; 2:1-10

- One bad choice Israel made is not driving out the Canaanites completely, and now things start to spiral downward. Why do you think this new generation did not know the Lord or the work that he had done for Israel? How would you imagine Joshua (if he were alive at that time) would feel about this?

→ NOTEBOOK

Turn to a new page to create a title page for the book of Judges. Write the title of the book, and what genre it is: Historical Narrative. Draw a picture or write a short summary of the passage. Older students may write a longer summary or write down key verse(s) of the passage, including 2:10.

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 15

Cycles

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The Israelites have started worshipping false idols and have turned away from following God. And now a cycle (or a series of events that keep repeating) will start that will happen throughout the book of Judges. "The cycles (disobedience, punishment, cry for help, deliverance) show how God demonstrated his power and mercy by delivering his people time after time after his justice had demanded that he bring punishment." (Bible Story Handbook) Sadly, it is also obvious that the leaders of the Israelites are just as bad as the people. In the cycle, the punishment they

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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experienced was in the form of oppression, being conquered by an enemy, or even being enslaved.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 2:11-23

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 16

Othniel

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

NOTE: There are two options for the reading today. For the second option of reading (3:7-26), preview the passage, as there is an instance of violence as King Eglon gets stabbed. However, the story is also a great example of the humanity included in the Bible.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today's reading introduces the first judge, Othniel. Recall that there are cycles in the book of Judges that involve disobedience, punishment, cry for help, deliverance. Each time that cycle happens, their decline into disobedience, idolatry, and sin is even worse. As we read, listen for those steps in the cycle.

→ READ & NARRATE

Younger Students: Judges 3:7-15

Option #2: Judges 3:7-26

→ NOTEBOOK

∞ Image Link: Cycle of Judges

Draw and/or label the cycle that is in the book of Judges. You can come up with your own words or use the following for the steps of the cycle: disobedience, punishment, cry for help, deliverance. An example is given at the link. (Your chart/cycle does not need to look exactly like this!) Older students can put verse numbers from today's reading about Othniel next to each step (i.e., Disobedience 3:7).

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 17

Deborah and Barak

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today's reading will introduce us to the next judge in Israel's history. The judges "were often as bad as the people. Deborah was certainly an exception to this, as she was a faithful prophetess and brought deliverance in association with the commander Barak...Deborah was first and foremost a prophetess, one who brought God's word to the people. People came to her for decisions because she would inquire of God for them. It is likely that in this particular instance they came to ask God what they should do about the Canaanite armies. She responded by sending for Barak and giving him God's orders." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 4:1-15

→ READ & NARRATE

Over the next couple of lessons, we will read a few passages from



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Manners & Customs to learn more about how the armies and groups fought at this time of the Old Testament.
Manners & Customs "The horse" p.213 "The horses of" - "back to Jezreel."; p.145 "Iron was originally" - "for the Temple."
Optional: As interest or time allows, the entire passage regarding workers with metal could be read. This gives a short history of the development of metal being used in the times of the Old Testament p.143-145 "workers of metal."

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 18

Deborah's Song

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Sisera went into battle confidently, knowing the Israelites were outnumbered and would seemingly be easy to conquer. But God used both human means (the swords of the Israelites) and divine means to defeat the Canaanites. Today's passage is a victory hymn written by Deborah. In it, we see further information as to the divine means God used to crush Sisera by sending a sudden flood to the Kishon River.

→ READ & NARRATE

Younger students: Judges 5:1-15, 20-21

Older students: Judges 5:1-31

- In verses 20 and 21, torrent refers to a flood of waters that overtook the army. If you were driving in chariots, how would a sudden flood of a river slow you down?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture of Deborah, Barak, or the battle they fought against Sisera, or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary or copy key verses down.

Optional: Try writing a short victory song or poem celebrating the victory of Israel over Sisera.

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 19

Gideon

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The Israelites experienced peace for 40 years under Deborah's judgeship (5:31b), but then their cycle of disobedience began again, and they were conquered by the Midianites. Let's ask the question that the books of Historical Narrative answer: And then what happened?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 6:1-4, 11-24

- Why do you think Gideon asked for a sign?

→ READ, VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: Terebinth tree

1. View the image of the terebinth tree, a relative of the oak tree.
2. The Midianites were a semi-nomadic tribe, which means they traveled

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from place to place at times. So they liked to attack when the crops had been recently harvested (v.3-5).

Manners & Customs "The Gezer Calendar" and "Grain crops" p.86-90 (Skip p.88-89) "By the time" - "for warmer days."; "Threshing" p.94 "The separation of" - "to his enemies."

- Take a couple of minutes to look at the schoolboy's calendar in the text box labeled "The Gezer Calendar." If you live in an area where crops are grown, how does your area's calendar match this ancient calendar?

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 20

Gideon and Tests

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

In today's reading, there are a few tests that take place. First of all, Gideon uses "the dew and the fleece for an oracle. In an oracle, a yes-or-no question was posed to deity, and some mechanism was designated for deity to answer...Since God had already sent an angel to tell him that he was supposed to lead the armies into battle, Gideon wanted to check to see if those orders were still in place." Once the normal result happened, Gideon flipped it because he still doubted. "So with great apology (appropriate, since God had already given instruction), he then asked for the indicator to be switched; having the fleece dry and the threshing floor wet. This does indeed show a lack of faith on his part." (Bible Story Handbook) The second tests have to do with how the warriors drink from the water. Gideon once again was being asked to put his faith in God, going before the Israelites to fight their enemies.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 6:25-40; 7:1-11

(In order to keep the story together, today's reading is a little longer than usual. If additional time is needed to finish today's reading, the next lesson time can be used.)

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students may write a longer summary or choose one or two main verses from the passage to copy into their notebooks.

WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 21

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 22

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

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Term 1

WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 23 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Joshua	
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Joshua	



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WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 25

Gideon's Battle

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Gideon has his army put together to go up against the Midianites. Today we will read about that battle.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 7:15b-18 (begin at "And he returned"), 19-23; 8:22-27, 33-35

- How did the Israelites respond after Gideon died? (v.33-35)

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs p.17 Text box titled "The Priest's Clothing"
"In the ancient world around Israel, just as the gods were fed (sacrifices) and housed (temples), they were also clothed (that is, the images were). It is possible that Gideon's ephod represented the clothing of Yahweh (not on an actual image) just as the ark was the footstool of Yahweh's throne." (Bible Story Handbook) The ephod could be used as an oracle to discern God's will. In this sense, this particular ephod was idolatrous and inappropriate.

Optional: Turn back to p.12-13 to look at the images of typical clothing during Bible times.

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 26

The Cycle of Judges

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

After Gideon, there were another 40 years of peace for the people of Israel. But sadly, the cycle begins again.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 10:6-18

- When strong enemies came up against them, why do you think the Israelites tended to turn away and begin worshiping the other people's gods? (v.6 "And they forsook the Lord and did not serve him.")
- Open your notebook to the drawing you did of the cycle of Israel in the book of Judges. How are you seeing this cycle in the life of the Israelites in our reading of Judges so far?

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 27

The Birth of Samson

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The cycles in the book of Judges "show how God demonstrated his power

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and mercy by delivering them time after time after his justice had demanded that he bring punishment." Samson is the next judge of Israel, and he is "worse than all the other judges as he pursued his own...personal agendas, yet God still used him to deliver the Israelites." (Bible Story Handbook) In the Bible, Samson, who we will meet today, and Samuel, who we will meet later in the year's readings, are the only two for whom the Nazirite vow extends to someone's entire lifetime. Typically, the vow was taken for a specific, limited time to show a high devotion and dedication.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 13:1-20, 24-25

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 28

Honey from a Lion

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

As we begin Judges 14, Samson is now grown up. He wants to marry a woman from the Philistines, but he is to be a deliverer of the Israelites. Is it a good idea for him to marry a Philistine woman?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 14:5-19

• "In ancient literature, kings and heroes were sometimes portrayed as killing a lion. While this episode fits a standard heroic feat, it also demonstrates Samson's disregard for his vow, as he did not hesitate to scoop honey from the corpse of the lion." (Bible Story Handbook) After reading this passage, what do you notice about Samson and how he acts or behaves? Does he fit your idea of a hero?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture of today's passage or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down a couple of main verses from the reading.

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 29

Samson's Revenge Against the Philistines

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 15:1, 3-20

→ READ & NARRATE

The passage from Manners & Customs in the Bible we will read today is a summary of warfare before there was a monarchy (kings over the entire nation of Israel), including some battles we have read about this year in Joshua, Judges, and now into First Samuel.

Manners & Customs p.260-262 "Warfare is an" - "no standing army."

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview today's passage for sensitive content regarding Samson's wife, her dad's offer of her sister, and the Philistines' subsequent reaction by burning up her and her father.



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WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 30

Delilah Manipulates Samson

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

NOTE: The following note may be helpful if any questions arise from today's reading, where in verse 15:20, it states that the "Lord had left him."

"In the Old Testament, the Spirit of the Lord was usually seen in empowering people to a task. Today we talk of the Spirit's indwelling people when they become Christians. These are very different things, and therefore this incident in Judges should not be viewed as the beginning of Samson's spiritual relationship with God. The endowment of the Spirit here had to do with his role as general." (Bible Story Handbook) Samson's choices are selfish, and yet God continues to use him as an instrument to accomplish His will.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Samson meets Delilah, a woman who took a bribe (payment) from the Philistines to help weaken and defeat Samson. She accepts 5,500 shekels of silver, which, at that time, a typical wage would only be about 10 to 12 shekels for an entire year's worth of work! "And then what happened?"

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 16:4-31

- Delilah gets the best of Samson, but in v.28 Samson asks God to give him strength one more time in order to defeat the Philistines. Why do you think God gave him strength in this situation?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of Samson and Delilah. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down one or more important verses from this passage.

• EXTRA HELPING

Read p.150-151 in Manners & Customs of Bible Times to find out more about weaving and the loom and pin Delilah used to attempt to defeat Samson.

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 31

Micah

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Do you recall what genre of books these are that we have been reading? (Historical Narrative) Typically, Historical Narrative books answer the question "and then what happened?" However, in these final chapters of Judges, that pattern changes a bit. These stories are not what happened *next*; rather, they tell stories of what happened *during* the time of the judges we have been reading about.

In the final chapters of the book of Judges, no further judges are introduced. "No note of Israel's sin, of outside oppression, of a cry for help, or of God's provision for a hero-judge to save the people. These chapters are simply additional bits of history that the editor apparently did not want to leave out." (Basic Bible Commentary) The stories may have been used to show the moral decay the people had experienced during the time of the judges.



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→ READ & NARRATE

Let's read the first of the stories in these ending chapters. Micah, whose name (ironically) means "Who is like Yahweh?," is introduced in verse 1. In verse 2, he's going to tell his mom that the money stolen from her was actually taken by him. How do you think his mom will respond to this? Let's read to find out what this mom and son do next.
Judges 17:1-13

- Did Micah's mother respond to his stealing the money in the way you thought she would? Why or why not?
- Read 17:6, a key verse of the book of Judges, again. What do you imagine it would be like to live in a land where this was how people were living?

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 32

The Danites Look for Land

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Judges 18:1-13
2. Manners & Customs "The dearth of priests"
Younger Students: p.327 "When the Jews" - "breaking the basic commandments."
Look at the picture of the priest on p.326. The ephod is the embroidered garment overlaying his tunic.
Older Students: "The Levites" p.325-327 "Levi, one of the" - "breaking the basic commandments."

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 33

Danites Move the Idols

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today we will read the second half of the story of the Danites. They have arrived at Micah's house and notice Micah's idols. What do you think they will do with them?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 18:14-31

- Why do you think the author takes care to include the fact that the priests of the Danites set up Micah's idols at their new place in v.30-31?

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 34

Naomi and Ruth

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; notebook; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The book of Judges ends by repeating the sad statement one more time: "In those days there was no king in Israel. Everyone did what was right in his own eyes." Today we will begin the book of Ruth, which begins with a



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verse saying the story took place while the judges were ruling. Elimelech moves his family away from the city of Bethlehem to Moab because there is a famine. Moabites were an enemy of the people of Israel, but in that land, Ruth, a Moabite woman, marries into Naomi's family and shows faithfulness.

Ruth is a short, four-chapter-long book that shines in the midst of the darkness, because the story of Ruth holds hope. While the book of Judges shows us God can still work through people who are disobedient, foolish, and selfish, the book of Ruth shows us what he can do through people who are faithful to him.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Ruth 1:1-18

"Whenever people were forced to leave the covenant Promised Land, it can be construed as either punishment or neglect of God. Since this story is in the judges period when the people were constantly unfaithful, we can infer that the famine was part of God's judgment. Drought and famine were included in the curses for violating the covenant (Deut. 28:23-24)." (Bible Story Handbook)

- How is her loyalty and faithfulness different from what most people chose in the book of Judges?

→ MAP WORK

📍 Map Resource: Manners & Customs

p.83 Locate the town of Bethlehem where Elimelech's family was from. Find Moab, where the family moved and Ruth was from. What body of water lies between the two locations? (Salt Sea or Dead Sea)

→ NOTEBOOK

Create a title page for the book of Ruth. Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's passage. Older students may write a longer summary or choose to copy down key verse(s) from the reading.

WEEK 6 📅 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 35

Boaz and Ruth Meet

📖 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Ruth and Naomi return to Bethlehem, where Naomi asks to be called by a new name.

→ READ & NARRATE

Ruth 1:19-2:13

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "Harvesting" p.93-94 "The flax was harvested" - "owned the crops."

Look at the images on p.92-93.

Optional: The passage previously read in Judges about "Threshing" can be discussed again, or if review is needed, can be read: p.94-95 "The separation" - "replaced the flints."

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WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 36

Harvest

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Ruth 2:14-3:5

- How do you think Boaz's kind treatment of Ruth encouraged Naomi?

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "Winnowing" p.96-97 "In the evening" - "was not stolen."

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 37

Boaz the Redeemer

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

In today's reading, Boaz refers to himself as Ruth's "redeemer." In the ancient world, a widow's (someone whose husband has died) family would step in to help and provide security for the widow. "This included involvement with the remarriage of those who had been widowed and were without descendants, because descendants provided for each family in the tribe from generation to generation. This is how land was passed and held in the family." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

Ruth 3:6-4:6

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: Boaz and Ruth by Gerbrand van den Eeckhout (1655)
View the image at the link. Does it match how you imagine the scene looked when Boaz and Ruth met? Why or why not?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of what has been happening in the story of Ruth and Boaz. Older students could write a longer summary, or copy down one or more key verses from the passage.

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 38

Blessings

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

NOTE: Two options are given for the reading about city gates. Choose the one that best fits your student(s).

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Hope is seen in the redemptive story of Boaz and Ruth. Blessings come to them because they are following after God. God is faithful to follow through on his promises.



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→ READ & NARRATE

Ruth 4:7-22

• Do you recall when the book of Ruth took place? (time of the judges) At the beginning of the book, the family left Bethlehem because of a famine, but at the end of the book, what are some evidences of the blessing Ruth and Boaz experienced because of the faithfulness of God? (Naomi holds her grandson on her lap; the implication is that there is no longer famine as the baby is able to be fed; Ruth and Boaz are happily married; and some students may notice that King David is part of their family line in the future, which means they are also in the genealogy of Jesus, our Redeemer.)

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "The gate"

Younger students: p.175-176 "The gates were heavily defended" - "always be open."

Older students, or for further information about gates of the city: p.174-176 "In the early" - "always be open."

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 39

Hannah Prays

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The next two books we will read are First and Second Samuel. These two books continue in the genre of Historical Narrative and will tell what happens next as Israel begins a historical time period of moving from judges to kings. In I Samuel, we meet Israel's final judge named Samuel. The books are named after him, as he is a man who held "three offices: Prophet, priest, and judge." God will eventually use Samuel as an instrument to bring in the reign of King David. (Bible Story Handbook). In today's reading, we will meet Hannah, who is Samuel's mother. She at first cannot have children, but God answers her prayer for a child because he is working to bring about his plan "to provide the king-maker (Samuel) of Israel through her."

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 1:1-28

→ NOTEBOOK

Create a title page for the book of First Samuel, which you can write as: I Samuel, or as First Samuel. Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students can create a title page, draw a picture, and write a longer summary of today's passage.

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 40

Hannah's Prayer & Eli's Sons

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Hannah has had a son and has committed him to the Lord's work. God had a divine reason and plan in mind to help the nation of Israel through Samuel. As he grows up, Samuel serves in the temple and helps Eli the



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priest. Dressed in an ephod and robe, Samuel was most likely helping Eli personally, but also learning priestly tasks. This may have included "tasks carried out by the Levites. These included preparing animals for sacrifice and taking care of what was left after the sacrifice. There was also wood and water to be hauled." (Bible Story Handbook) Sadly, we will learn that Eli the priest had sons who were disobedient, and Eli was not doing much to stop their misbehavior. Recall that this is still the time of the judges in the life of Israel, and we see how much that disobedience had corrupted every aspect of society, including the priests.

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 2:1-21

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 41

Eli's Sons

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Eli's sons were corrupting the priestly office, and Eli was not doing anything to stop it.

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 2:22-36

- What do you recall about what a priest's role (or job) was to do? (represent the people before God, bring sacrifices, etc.) Why would this be a very important role?

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 42

Samuel's Call

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs; notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

While Eli's sons and Eli are struggling (and failing) to keep the priesthood holy, Samuel continues to grow older. In today's reading, Samuel will receive a special call from the Lord.

→ READ & NARRATE

First, we will read from Manners & Customs about what a prophet in Old Testament times did and what his role was.

Younger students: p.330-331 "A person became" - "and in truth."

Older students: "The prophets" p.328-331 "Alongside the priests" - "and in truth."

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 3:1-21

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a summary of the passage. Older students may write a longer summary, or copy down a verse or more from today's reading. The student may also record any notes of interest regarding what a prophet's role was at the time of I Samuel.



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WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 43

Philistines Capture the Ark

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

NOTE: Two parts of the story can be added in as appropriate for your student(s):

1. "The story of the ark brings an end to the judges period of history, as God's ultimate judgment on the people was to abandon them to their oppressors. He did this by leaving the land and bringing judgement on the Philistines without raising up a judge."
2. A note on the god Dagon and the ark: "The first time Dagon fell in front of the ark, it was as though he was bowing before God." The second time, "his head and arms fell off, which is an indication that he had been slain in battle. In the ancient world enemy casualties were sometimes counted by making a pile of the heads or hand of the slain. The destruction of Dagon was a very visible way for Yahweh to show the Philistines that he had not been defeated." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The ark of the covenant is captured by the Philistines in the chapters we will read from today. Let's look at some information about the ark of the covenant before reading the passage.

Manners & Customs

1. Turn to p.301 and look at the image of the ark of the covenant based on the description from passages in the Bible. While nobody knows where the ark is located currently, artists have drawn or tried to show what it possibly looked like. Take a moment to look at the image of the priest as well. Do you remember the name of the overlay he is wearing? (an ephod)
2. Read p.331-332 "Holy objects"
Younger students: p.331 "In the Jewish" - "served the same purpose."
Older students, or as time and interest allow: p.331-333 "In the Jewish" - "of the house." View the image of the priest on p.333. What do you notice about what he is holding, reading, and wearing?

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 4:1-11; 5:1-11

- What does this story tell us about the power of God?

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 44

We Want a King!

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

When the Israelites moved into the land of Canaan, they were separated into their tribes, and there was no central government over them. In today's reading, they will ask Samuel for a king. All the way back to Genesis 17:6, God had said there would be kings from Israel, so the kingship was not wrong. However, "the problem is the reason the people gave for wanting a king. They had come to believe that their problem was a political one, so they were seeking a political solution. In reality their problem was a spiritual one that required a spiritual solution." (Bible Story Handbook)

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→ READ & NARRATE I Samuel 7:5-6, 12-17; 8:4-18 • Why do the Israelites want a king? How does Samuel react to this request? Why?	
WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 45 <i>Catch-Up Day</i> → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 46 <i>Catch-Up Day</i> → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 47 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Judges or Ruth	
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 48 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Judges or Ruth	



Term 3

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 49

Samuel Meets Saul

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

When the people of Israel begged for a king, what did Samuel warn them would happen if they had a king? (taxes, sons and daughters being put to work and into battles for the king) How do you think the people will respond to Samuel's wise words?

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 8:19-22; 9:1-14

- How is Saul described? Can you imagine what you might feel about having a new king?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down key verse(s) from the passage.

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 50

Samuel Anoints Saul as King

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs; notebook (optional)

NOTE: In today's reading, it states that the "Spirit of the Lord rushed upon Saul." To aid with any questions that may arise from this: "In the Old Testament, the Spirit of the Lord was usually seen in empowering people to a task. Today we talk of the Spirit's indwelling people when they become Christians. These are very different things. This incident should not be viewed as the beginning of Saul's spiritual relationship with God." (Bible Story Handbook) Saul is anointed and set aside for a task God has given him to accomplish.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 9:15-10:1; 10:9-13, 17-24

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "Olive oil" p.106-110 (skipping 108-109) "Olive oil took" - "Lord anointed him."

→ NOTEBOOK

Optional: As time allows, draw a picture or write a short summary of today's passage. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down key verses.

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 51

Samuel's Farewell Address

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?



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→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Chapter 12 is Samuel's farewell address to the people of Israel.
I Samuel 12:1-25

- How do you think Samuel, as an old man now, is feeling as he gives this message to the people?
- Samuel gives a short review of Israel's history to the people. Why is it important for them to remember what has happened in their history?

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 52

Saul is Rejected as King

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

NOTE: We will skip over some verses for the sake of time and because chapter 14 deals with the destruction of the Amalekites.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Saul disobeys God and, as a result, God rejects Saul as king. Saul had been battling other nations, and in one battle, he and his soldiers kept some of the enemy's best animals, counter to what they had been told to do. Samuel will confront Saul with his disobedience. Do you think Saul will listen?

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 15:10-31

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down key verses.

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 53

David Plays for Saul

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Next in the book of I Samuel, the focus begins to shift to the life of David. There are differences between Saul and David and how they followed after God. One Bible commentator (someone who studies and helps explain the Bible) states: "I don't at all mean that David was an entirely good man, or Saul an entirely bad man. No, they were both men with good and evil in them. But they differed greatly in the attitude of their hearts towards God. The Bible speaks of David with decided approval, and of Saul with decided blame. But you must not therefore think it your duty to look only for good in the one, and for evil in the other...You will miss the best of the Bible teaching unless you are quite honest and candid, giving full weight to the evil and the good in each of its characters." (J. Paterson Smyth)

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 16:1-17, 20-23

- What does this passage say about what is important to God? (See v.6-7.) How would you explain that if someone asked you what that meant?



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→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: David Playing the Harp for Saul
View the image of David playing for King Saul.

- What do you notice about the painting? How would you feel about having to play calming music for an upset king?

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 54

David v. Goliath

📖 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

In the next two lessons, we will read the story of David going up against Goliath, a tough, intimidating opponent who is mocking or taunting (in today's sports world, we might call it "trash-talking") the Israelites. "In the ancient world people believed that the gods fought in conjunction with the human armies they supported and that the armies with the stronger god would prevail...As Goliath defied Israel's armies, he was also defying their God—the two cannot be separated. David became indignant for the Lord's reputation, which is a demonstration that he had the quality that God was looking for in a king." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 17:1-27

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down one or more key verses from the passage.

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 55

David Defeats Goliath

📖 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs; notebook (optional)

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Today we will read the rest of the story of David and Goliath. In this story, we see that God is faithful to what he promised. We also see characteristics of David that help show why he was chosen by God as the next king of Israel.

I Samuel 17:28-53

→ READ & NARRATE

Manners & Customs "The foot-soldier" p.264-265 "During the rise" - "the Assyrian army."

→ NOTEBOOK

Optional: If you would like to, add more to your drawing you began last time in your notebook, or add any additional information to your summary that you would like to.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the verses regarding David victoriously cutting off Goliath's head after defeating him (v.51-54). One option is to stop at verse 50, then skip to v.55.



Term 3

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 56

David and Jonathan's Friendship

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

David is yet to be crowned king, but after his victory over Goliath, and over the next few chapters, he "gained the support of every group, beginning with the crown prince, Jonathan." Jonathan is the son of Saul, but he begins a very loyal friendship with David, showing no jealousy, but rather love and a recognition that David was God's chosen next king of Israel. This would be unlikely, because as the son of the king, Jonathan would have been the one to assume the throne after Saul died. Instead, God had specifically chosen David, and Jonathan realizes that.

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 18:1-4; 19:1-7; 20:1-17

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 57

David and Jonathan

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

As we continue in I Samuel, do you remember what genre or group of books I and 2 Samuel belong to? (Historical Narrative) Today we will find out what happens next in the narrative, or story, that the author is telling. In the story of David and Goliath, of David and King Saul, or now of David and Jonathan, what are these stories telling us about who God is?

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 20:18-42

- What do you think about King Saul's reaction to his son Jonathan? Does that seem like a choice a good leader would make? Why or why not?

→ NOTEBOOK

Add the story of David and Jonathan to your notebook either through a drawing or a written-out summary. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down a verse or two from the passage. A question to consider as you write would be: What characteristics did Jonathan and David show in comparison with King Saul?

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 58

David Spares Saul's Life

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today's reading will finish up the book of I Samuel. We will read about David sparing Saul's life, which means David had a chance to punish and defeat Saul, but instead let him go.

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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→ READ & NARRATE

1 Samuel 24:1-22; 25:1

- Samuel has now died. Imagine the life he lived—leading, judging, being a prophet, and helping put both Saul and David into their roles as king of Israel. What did you notice about Samuel's life and how he lived?

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 59

The Davidic Covenant

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

We have reached Second Samuel. When the book was originally written, it was all one book; however, it was so long that it couldn't fit onto one scroll, so the book was divided into two parts. In Second Samuel, we will now see David become king over Israel. The verses we will read today show how, now that "David had been anointed and had shown his mettle, the text develops over many chapters how David gradually gained expressions of support." (Bible Story Handbook) Once David is on the throne, God makes a covenant with him.

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 1:2-4, 11-12; 2:8-11; 5:1-4, 17-21; 6:12-19

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 60

Davidic Covenant

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

NOTE: Today's reading is a bit longer, so the focus will be on the Bible reading.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

God now makes a covenant with David. In chapter 6:2, the ark of the covenant has been returned to Israel and returned to a "central positioning." God will now bless the nation of Israel through King David. David wants to build a temple for God, which is not an unusual thing for a king to do for the god of the people; however, God says he will "establish a house (dynasty) for David...By separating the temple building from the covenant, it is made clear that David did not gain God's favor for his dynasty by building the temple." (Bible Story Handbook) The last part of the reading is a prayer of response from David to God.

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 7:1-29

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 61

David's Kindness to Mephibosheth

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

David finds out that there was a member of Saul's family who was still



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alive. This was Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan. David shows kindness and loyalty to the promise he had made to Saul and Jonathan that he would treat anyone in their family line well. David is following through on what he had promised.

Mephibosheth was allowed to eat at the king's table, which "was a way of indicating that someone was under royal protection and care. Whether that person actually ate at the same table or not, provisions or rations were supplied from the king's house." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 9:1-13

- Why would a new king not want anyone from the last (or previous) king's family to still be alive? (Because he was in the line of Saul, he could take over the throne.)
- God had chosen David to be king, and much of what happens in these chapters shows that he is not winning power by making political moves or using strategy to gain power; rather, he is gaining the support of the people and is being affirmed as God's choice for the throne over Israel.

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture of today's reading or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down a verse or more from the passage.

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 62

David and Bathsheba

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

David was anointed as God's chosen for the throne and has shown thus far that he has character and wishes to follow God's leading. However, in today's story, David fails to make the right choice. He abuses his power and is held accountable by God for this failure.

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 11:1-21

David used his power to "achieve his own sinful ends." As his decisions in this passage affect his family, he will experience much sorrow, reaping the consequences of his sinful choices.

★ TEACHER NOTE

You can decide whether the story of David and Bathsheba is appropriate for your students.

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 63

The Sheep Owner

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

After it is announced that Uriah had died in battle, Nathan the prophet comes to David and tells him a story about a sheep owner. The story is of an owner who abuses their power, just as David had done.

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 11:25-12:7; 13-15



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→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of your reading. Older students may write a longer summary.

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 64

Absalom

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Absalom was a son of King David who turned against him and wanted to take over the throne. He tried to do this by gathering people to be on his side against his father, David.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

2 Samuel 15:1-15, 25-31

- Does what is happening in this passage (i.e., David crying, walking barefoot with his head covered) seem like how you would picture a king behaving? Why or why not?

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 65

David Cries Over Absalom

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Absalom is killed as he continues to try to take over his father's throne. When King David hears this news, he is very upset about the loss of his son, but Joab comes and confronts him.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

2 Samuel 18:19-33; 19:1-8

- Do you think it makes sense that David is upset about the loss of his son who tried to trick him and take over his throne? Why or why not?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of your reading. Older students may write a longer summary.

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 66

Song of Deliverance

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Open your Bible to 2 Samuel 22. What does the heading say? (David's Song of Deliverance) David was a great writer of poetry and songs. He was writing his psalms while he was experiencing the life situations that were causing him to experience joy, sorrow, repentance, or any number of emotions. Next lesson, we will read a Psalm that directly ties into 2 Samuel 22. Let's start by reading the first part of 2 Samuel 22: Read 2 Samuel 22:1-31.



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- What are some ways David describes God in this song? (a rock, fortress, deliverer, rescues him, etc.)
- What are some feelings or emotions you hear in this song?

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 67

David's Songs

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

1. 2 Samuel 22:32-51
2. As we discussed last lesson, the book of Psalms in the Bible contains many of King David's songs and poems. Thirteen psalms were written during the events of 1 & 2 Samuel. In fact, chapter 22 of 2 Samuel is found in the book of Psalms. Find Psalm 18 in your Bible. Read the heading (The choirmaster. A Psalm of David...). Then begin reading Psalm 18. Compare this to 2 Samuel 22. Is it the same?

Optional:

∞ Link: Psalms Written During 1 & 2 Samuel

Look at the linked list of psalms written during 1 & 2 Samuel. Pick one to look up and read.

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 68

David's Final Words

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Today we will finish up our reading in the book of 2 Samuel, and we will read Psalm 23, written by King David.

2 Samuel 23:1-7

Psalm 23

- David was God's chosen king for the nation of Israel. How was David a "man after God's own heart"?

→ NOTEBOOK

In your notebook, draw a picture showing something you have learned about King David or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary.

WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 69

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 70

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

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WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 71 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: 1 or 2 Samuel	
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 72 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: 1 or 2 Samuel	

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

Examination

Term 1 · Tell about Joshua leading the people into Canaan. OR Tell about the fall of the city of Jericho.

Term 2 · Tell the story of Gideon the judge. OR Tell the story of Ruth and Boaz.

Term 3 · Tell about King Saul OR about David and Goliath.